control programmes can potentially be run by the Union government, a state government, or the municipality. By the subsidiarity principle, these should lie at the municipality as this is the lowest possible level.

This makes sense because at the local level, there is the best local knowledge in prioritizing problems and devising solutions. There is also greater accountability, as voters are closest to the local government.

Implicit in the subsidiarity principle is a great value for local knowledge. Social systems are not physical systems. In physics, Newton's laws work everywhere, but social systems have complex interrelationships that vary strongly with culture, institutions and history. An expert on urban transport policy in London is not an expert on urban transport policy in Pune. An expert on urban transport policy in Pune is not an expert on urban transport policy in Patna. Each place has its own rhythm, and we require deep local knowledge in every corner of the world in order to understand problems and solve them. In his book *Seeing Like a State*, the great political scientist, James C. Scott, has used the word *metis* to convey deep experiential local knowledge. [2] Each of us has to study our backyard, build knowledge about it, and solve problems in it.

This approach has far-reaching consequences.

It implies that on List 2 and List 3 questions, states have to develop their own capabilities for policy planning and execution. Each state will have to cultivate its own ecosystem of intellectuals, think tanks, staff that supports legislators, debates about legislation, and policy capabilities in the bureaucracy.

Health policy in Madhya Pradesh is as complex as health policy in Germany, considering that the two countries have a similar population. This suggests that the health policy capabilities in Madhya Pradesh—data sets, researchers, think tanks, government—need to match the richness of what is found in Germany. A similar development of capabilities in the policy process is required in the large cities. After all, large cities in India match the population of many countries.

Conversely, the excessive concentration of these policy capabilities in New Delhi will have to diffuse out to locations all over India. Our